CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 17

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ The house is too cold.
- ◯ The firewood is too wet.
- ◯ The heaters won't turn on.
- ◯ The ceiling fan won't spin.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ confused
- ◯ helpful
- ◯ angry
- ◯ funny

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ rainy
- ◯ sunny
- ◯ colder
- ◯ warmer

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ return it to the woman
- ◯ store it in the house
- ◯ give it to someone else
- ◯ leave it in the living room

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ He thinks the extra heater won't work.
- ◯ He believes the heater is easy to use.
- ◯ He expected a larger heater.
- ◯ He won't use the extra heater.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ to deliver a stack of firewood
- ◯ to help rid the house of smoke
- ◯ to explain how to use the stove
- ◯ to help the man stack firewood

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ He moved the handle too far.
- ◯ He moved the handle too many times.
- ◯ He moved the wrong handle.
- ◯ He moved the handle in the wrong direction.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ The man has asked her to return.
- ◯ She wants to make sure all is well.
- ◯ The man will pay her for the firewood then.
- ◯ She will bring the man something else.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a Government of Ontario employee
- ◯ an internet company representative
- ◯ the man's personal assistant
- ◯ a secretary at an auto garage

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ His internet is broken.
- ◯ He's using public Wi-Fi.
- ◯ He forgot his password.
- ◯ His computer is slow.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ tell the man his appointment date
- ◯ ask the man when he's available
- ◯ ask the man which date he prefers
- ◯ ask the man to re-schedule an appointment

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ His calendar is in error.
- ◯ His appointments conflict.
- ◯ His home internet is slow.
- ◯ His car has broken down.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ ignores the woman's recommendation
- ◯ reschedules his CableTron appointment
- ◯ goes along with the woman's plan
- ◯ refuses the woman's request

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ so more people can hear live music
- ◯ so she can help people learn to play music
- ◯ so she can practice with her group
- ◯ so students can play music together

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ advertising so people know about them
- ◯ cleaning up well after them
- ◯ including everyone who comes
- ◯ keeping the noise level acceptable

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a development plan
- ◯ a space to meet
- ◯ agreement of 10 people
- ◯ a letter from a professor

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a concert
- ◯ a festival
- ◯ a course
- ◯ a competition

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ at the Student Centre
- ◯ at the local pub
- ◯ in empty classrooms
- ◯ in student residence

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ the man
- ◯ three executives
- ◯ the woman
- ◯ a group of students

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The raccoons used the shed to _____
- ◯ keep warm.
- ◯ sleep at night.
- ◯ hide from Mr. Chang.
- ◯ have their babies.

2. A negative result was that Mr. Chang _____
- ◯ worried about his children.
- ◯ began watching too much TV.
- ◯ couldn't use his backyard.
- ◯ had to fix the hole.

3. A positive result was that Mr. Chang's _____
- ◯ children could play with the raccoons.
- ◯ children liked watching the raccoons.
- ◯ shed was large enough for the raccoons.
- ◯ shed was put to good use.

4. In the future, Mr. Chang will _____
- ◯ repair the shed.
- ◯ build a new shed.
- ◯ leave holes for raccoons.
- ◯ allow raccoons in the yard.

5. According to the wildlife expert, raccoons _____
- ◯ are common in cities.
- ◯ are afraid of humans.
- ◯ are very dangerous.
- ◯ make good pets.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What are the roles of these three people?
- ◯ managers of a volunteer organization
- ◯ distributors of medical supplies
- ◯ trainers of hospital volunteers
- ◯ cashiers at the hospital gift shop

2. What is the primary purpose of their meeting?
- ◯ to investigate a problem
- ◯ to take stock of inventory
- ◯ to follow up on a meeting
- ◯ to discuss volunteer workers

3. Why does Jason, the man on the left, ask so many questions?
- ◯ He thinks Janet knows what happened.
- ◯ He is unaware of the state of affairs.
- ◯ He disagrees that there is a problem.
- ◯ He wants to attract their attention.

4. What is the purpose of the gift shop?
- ◯ to collect funds for hospital supplies
- ◯ to provide volunteering opportunities
- ◯ to raise money for volunteer projects
- ◯ to finance the hospital's expansion

5. Why does Alec, the man in the middle, rule out hospital staff as suspects?
- ◯ The staff are aware of the security camera.
- ◯ The staff reported the missing inventory.
- ◯ The staff support the gift shop.
- ◯ The staff undergo security checks.

6. How does the meeting end?
- ◯ They remain conflicted about what to do.
- ◯ They have each taken on a specific task.
- ◯ They decide to postpone the investigation.
- ◯ They have prepared a report for the hospital.

PART 5

7. Why isn't the on-approval system working?

- ◯ People fail to keep track of items taken.
- ◯ Volunteers are unaware of the notebook.
- ◯ The same items are always being taken.
- ◯ Too much time is wasted checking inventory.

8. What is one possible explanation given for the situation?

- ◯ Customers know the shop lacks proper security.
- ◯ The shop's inventory lists are inaccurate.
- ◯ Shop workers have reduced stock prices.
- ◯ Shop workers have neglected to pay for items.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. One advantage of choosing a used car is _____

- ◯ inexpensive insurance.
- ◯ consumer protection laws.
- ◯ access to the car's history.
- ◯ a variety of vehicle options.

2. For business owner Jane Repton, buying a used car involves _____

- ◯ a compromise.
- ◯ a legal ordeal.
- ◯ a lot of time.
- ◯ a lot of luck.

3. It can be inferred that McNab _____

- ◯ doesn't care how much a car costs him.
- ◯ likes all the optional features of new cars.
- ◯ drives more than 20,000 kilometers per year.
- ◯ values short-term performance of a car.

4. Car salesperson Ron McNab prefers buying a new car because _____

- ◯ new cars require less paperwork.
- ◯ new cars can be much better on gas.
- ◯ he doesn't mind paying monthly fees.
- ◯ he thinks they're the cheapest option.

5. Lawyer Tom Purdy is most interested in _____

- ◯ status and style.
- ◯ convenience.
- ◯ a clear contract.
- ◯ safety.

6. The speaker's primary purpose is to _____

- ◯ facilitate an academic debate.
- ◯ solicit audience participation.
- ◯ introduce entertaining guests.
- ◯ provide helpful information.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	The house is too cold.
Question 2	helpful
Question 3	warmer
Question 4	store it in the house
Question 5	He believes the heater is easy to use.
Question 6	to explain how to use the stove
Question 7	He moved the handle in the wrong direction.
Question 8	She wants to make sure all is well.

PART 2	
Question 1	an internet company representative
Question 2	He's using public Wi-Fi.
Question 3	tell the man his appointment date
Question 4	His appointments conflict.
Question 5	goes along with the woman's plan

PART 3	
Question 1	so students can play music together
Question 2	keeping the noise level acceptable
Question 3	agreement of 10 people
Question 4	a concert
Question 5	in empty classrooms
Question 6	the woman

PART 4	
Question 1	have their babies.
Question 2	couldn't use his backyard.
Question 3	children liked watching the raccoons.
Question 4	repair the shed.
Question 5	are common in cities.

PART 5	
Question 1	managers of a volunteer organization
Question 2	to investigate a problem
Question 3	He is unaware of the state of affairs.
Question 4	to collect funds for hospital supplies
Question 5	The staff support the gift shop.
Question 6	They have each taken on a specific task.
Question 7	People fail to keep track of items taken.
Question 8	Shop workers have neglected to pay for items.

PART 6	
Question 1	inexpensive insurance.
Question 2	a compromise.
Question 3	drives more than 20,000 kilometers per year.
Question 4	new cars can be much better on gas.
Question 5	convenience.
Question 6	provide helpful information.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. It takes place in the house that the man is renting from the woman.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Hello, Mr. Adler, you asked me to come over?

MAN: Yes, thanks, please come in.

WOMAN: What seems to be the problem?

MAN: Well, I know it's sunny outside, but inside it's so cold! I have both heaters turned on, but I'm still freezing. The house is small and I thought it would be easy to heat, but I see now that the ceilings are high. I turned the ceiling fan on, to push the hot air down, but it's pulling the hot air up. I can't figure out how to make it change direction.

WOMAN: You can't. The fan is only for the summer. But this cold weather is very unusual. Normally, it's warmer than this.

MAN: Do you know how long it will last?

WOMAN: They say only for a few days. Unfortunately, they're calling for rain after that. But I can have some firewood delivered, if you like.

MAN: Um . . . Could you show me how to use the woodstove first?

WOMAN: Of course!

MAN: Okay . . . then, yes, I'd like some firewood delivered.

WOMAN: All right, but it probably won't get here until tomorrow. In the meantime, I'll bring over another heater for you.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. What is the man's main complaint?
2. Which word best describes the woman?
3. What is the weather normally like?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Hello?

MAN: Oh, come in.

WOMAN: Here's the extra heater. Where would you like it?

MAN: Right here in the living room is perfect. In the corner so I don't trip over it.

WOMAN: Okay, this is the button to turn it on. And this—

MAN: —is the button to turn it off, yes, yes. And I see that I can set the temperature. And then it will shut off by itself, right?

WOMAN: Yes. Afterwards, when you don't need it anymore, just put it away in the closet or something. It'll be good to have an extra heater here.

MAN: Okay—and thanks for bringing it over so quickly.

Now answer questions 4-5.

4. What should the man do with the heater later?
5. What is likely true of the man?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: The wood has been delivered, I see.

MAN: Yes, thank you. I asked them to stack it near the door.

WOMAN: Good. Okay, now before you light the fire, slide the damper—this handle—to the right to open the chimney. Otherwise, the house will fill with smoke.

MAN: Like this?

WOMAN: No, to the right.

MAN: Ah. And then I put some wood into the stove?

WOMAN: No, first, crumple up some newspaper . . . next you put in some small pieces of wood . . . and then you light it. Once there is a nice, small fire, you can put in bigger pieces of wood, one at a time, carefully. Make sure you always close the door though.

MAN: And when the fire is completely out, I turn the handle to close the chimney? To the left?

WOMAN: Yes, but just in case, I'll come back later.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. What is the purpose of the woman's visit?
7. What did the man do wrong when he opened the chimney?
8. Why does the woman say she'll come back later?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a phone conversation between a man and a woman.

MAN: Hi, can I help you?

WOMAN: Hi, this is Charlene at CableTron calling. We have an installation date for you.

MAN: CableTron! Great, finally! I've survived three weeks in my apartment without the internet, and I'm starting to lose my mind. Let me just log into my calendar here . . . hmm . . . Sorry, the internet is a little slow in this coffee shop.

WOMAN: It'll be a lot faster in your home with CableTron. When you placed your service order, you said you were available in the mornings. Our installation technician will come to your house between 7:30 am and 12:00 noon on Thursday, April 10.

MAN: Oh no . . . that's the day I'm supposed to bring my car to the auto shop for a mechanical check. I'm new to this province, and my car needs a safety inspection before I can register it in Ontario. Both have to be done by the 15th.

WOMAN: If you can't take our April 10th appointment, the next available one will be April 18th. I'm sorry, but we're unbelievably busy this time of year. Can you change your car appointment, by any chance?

MAN: Good question. Well, what do you think . . . Which do I need more urgently right now: the internet or my car?

WOMAN: I'm afraid you're asking the wrong person! I'm a computer geek who doesn't drive and rides her bike everywhere, so I know which one I'd pick. But I'm biased.

MAN: I'm guessing the mechanics have a bit more flexibility in their schedule than CableTron, so I'll go for the internet installation. I'll call the garage when I get off the phone. I'm pretty sure they can accommodate.

WOMAN: I hope so. But if you need to reschedule your CableTron installation, please call us 48 hours in advance. And by the way, welcome to the province of Ontario.

MAN: Thank you! I'll see your technician on the 10th.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Who is the woman?
2. Why does the man have difficulty logging in?
3. What did the woman intend to do with this phone call?
4. Why does the phone conversation frustrate the man?
5. What does the man do in the end?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a woman gets information about student clubs.

WOMAN: Hi! I'm looking to start a college club and I was told that the Student Society office was the right place to ask.

MAN: I can definitely help you out with that. What kind of club are you interested in starting?

WOMAN: Well, I found a brochure of clubs around campus and I noticed there wasn't a music club! I play guitar and I sing, and I thought maybe it would be fun to start a club so students could get together and make some music!

MAN: That's awesome! Okay, let's get you started. You will need ten students who support your club and will sign a petition to launch your club. There's a special day next week . . . club day . . . where you can set up a table with posters or signs to gain students' interest in your club.

WOMAN: That sounds fun! I'm sure I can get at least ten people interested. Is there funding for the club?

MAN: Yes, if you get ten signatures and start your club, the Student Society budgets $40 to new clubs and that money can be used towards anything, such as event planning or food. If you're looking for additional funding, you could apply for a grant of up to $300.

WOMAN: Wow! Maybe in the future we could even put on a concert at the college pub or something. And where do clubs usually meet? Do they book rooms?

MAN: Clubs get the privilege of accessing a lot of college space, like any of the rooms or lecture halls. You could even hold club meetings outdoors! The only thing you'd have to be careful about is the noise level, as you're going to be a music club. I'd recommend the Couch Lounge next to the college pub. You can be loud, and there's even a piano there.

WOMAN: Great! Is there a form I need to fill out?

MAN: Ah yes. Are you going to be the president of the club? There can be up to three executives.

WOMAN: Just me for now!

MAN: Perfect. Fill out the form and get your ten signatures, then we can process your application.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why does the woman want to start a music club?
2. What must the woman think about when planning their sessions?
3. What does the woman need to start a club?
4. What kind of event is the woman thinking of organizing?
5. Where do clubs usually meet?
6. Who will lead the club?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about urban wildlife.

A resident of Lethbridge, Alberta, has lost the use of his backyard due to a family of unexpected guests. Henry Chang says a pair of raccoons gave birth to a litter of baby raccoons in his storage shed, a wooden structure where he keeps his tools. Chang said that he hadn't renovated the shed yet because it's old and has a hole in the side. He guessed the raccoons thought it was a good place to raise a family. Chang soon discovered he could not enter his backyard at all, as parent raccoons are fiercely protective and aggressive when raising their young. On the bright side, however, Chang joked that he doesn't have to tell his children to stop watching T.V. because they're too busy watching the raccoon family from the living room.

Even so, Chang plans to fix the shed after the raccoons leave so that the same problem doesn't happen again next year. Local wildlife expert James Wade reminds residents that urban raccoons are very common, but certain steps can be taken to keep them out of our houses and backyards. Wade said the best approach was to block holes in places where raccoons may nest.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three people—one woman and two men. They are discussing a situation that is happening in the hospital gift shop.

Janet: Thanks for getting together today. We need to talk about the situation at the hospital gift shop. We need to understand exactly what's going on so we can report at the Hospital Auxiliary meeting next week.

Jason: What situation? I haven't heard anything.

Alec: Haven't you noticed that some of the stock has been disappearing more quickly than usual? If you check the sales records, sales haven't been going up, if anything they've been going down lately.

Jason: How can that be? Doesn't everybody know that we're a volunteer organization and that all the money we raise there goes to buying medical supplies?

Alec: Well, you'd think so! I mean certainly, the staff appreciate the work that we do. I'm positive it's no one from staff involved.

Jason: So are you saying that somebody has stolen the stock? One of the volunteers? Or a customer? And that someone is stealing money from the cash register? That would have to be one of the gift shop volunteers, right?

Alec: It's just too dreadful to think about. But we have to decide what we're going to do about the situation.

Janet: I think first we should compare the computer inventory with what we actually have in the store. That way, we can identify what's missing and how much money has actually been lost.

Alec: That's a good idea. You know, maybe it's someone from staff who's just taken something home on approval and forgot to pay for it. I mean, maybe that's all that's happening.

Jason: Well, there should be a record so that we can tell at a glance what hasn't been paid for yet and by whom.

Janet: There is—there's a notebook. Maybe people have forgotten about it. You know what, we should just get rid of on-approval privilege. It's always been a nuisance.

Jason: Maybe we should install a security camera. That way, if the problem continues, we can know exactly what's happening, and we can involve the police. I could price some different cameras and then bring up the idea at the next meeting.

Alec: I can call all the volunteers who work in the gift shop and let them know to be more to watchful. That way, they'll know that we are aware there's a theft problem going on. If it is a volunteer involved, maybe that will resolve the issue.

Janet: First, let's get the inventory done and see how serious the situation actually is. Maybe the shelves just look empty and it's not as bad as we think it is. I can do it tomorrow morning.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about options for acquiring a car.

Welcome, everyone, to today's community centre workshop on purchasing a vehicle. Buying a car can certainly seem like a daunting task, but it's not actually as complicated as it seems. The fact of the matter is, what you need really depends on why you need it. This morning we will explore three options to help you make your decision: buying a used car, buying a new car, and leasing a new car.

Business owner Jane Repton prefers to buy a used car because it's the cheapest option. Not only is the vehicle itself cheap, but insurance for the vehicle will also be low-cost since you'd probably just get the minimum—the insurance required by law. Presumably you wouldn't get replacement insurance: if the car is damaged beyond repair in an accident, you just get rid of it and buy another one. That being said, buying a used car can be risky because there's no warranty: you'll have to pay for any repairs yourself. And even Repton admits that used cars can be unreliable. She admits that she takes the bus to work more often than she'd like.

Car salesperson Ron McNab says that if you depend heavily on your vehicle, you should go with a new car. If you lease, there's a limit of 20,000 kilometers annually; more than that and it'll cost you. So McNab prefers to buy. Another advantage of buying new is that you know the vehicle's history from day one, and you'll be the one managing its long-term condition. McNab always chooses a new car. Yes, they're more expensive than used cars, but it's possible to get a car loan with no interest—'zero-percent financing,' they call it. Plus, with a new car, you can get up-to-date safety features and the best fuel economy.

On the other hand, lawyer Tom Purdy prefers to lease cars. He pays the monthly fee, and when the lease is up, he turns the car in and leases a new one. The reason he prefers to lease is because the company leasing the car looks after everything, including maintenance and repairs. All the driver has to do is get gas and pay the monthly premium. According to Purdy, it's hassle-free driving. However, Repton and McNab agree that they would never lease, claiming that it takes a lawyer to understand all the legal jargon in the contract.